18.4 Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I keep seeing the explosion in my dreams." • "I jump at any loud sound." **Objective** • Nightmares and flashbacks • Hypervigilant • Exaggerated startle	**ACTUAL** Post-trauma syndrome related to exposure to a traumatic event as evidenced by flashbacks, nightmares and hypervigilance.	• Fewer intrusive symptoms and use of grounding techniques within 2 weeks.	• Provide a safe, predictable setting. • Listen without pushing for details of the trauma. • Teach grounding and breathing techniques. • Give medication as prescribed. • Refer for trauma-focused therapy.	• Outcome reached when he uses the techniques and symptoms ease.
Subjective • "I sleep 2 or 3 hours only." **Objective** • Exhausted • Irritable	**ACTUAL** Ineffective sleep pattern related to nightmares as evidenced by short sleep duration and irritability.	• Better sleep within 2 weeks.	• Teach sleep hygiene. • Set up a relaxation routine before sleep. • Give prescribed medication for nightmares if ordered.	• Considered met as sleep improves.
Subjective • "Sometimes I drink to forget." **Objective** • Drinking more alcohol	**RISK** Risk for impaired resilience as evidenced by risk factors: use of alcohol to cope with trauma symptoms.	• Names safer ways of coping.	• Explain how alcohol makes the symptoms worse. • Offer referral to addiction services. • Draw on his support network.	• Goal reached once safer strategies are named.

*References for this care plan: [31], [35], [82]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.